WEEK 02 / INDEPENDENT STUDY

Vocabulary, Grammar & Exam Skills

A compact revision companion to the three-chapter theory class. Original examples throughout; no answers to the academy exercises.

> Learn the method. Make your own decisions.

Use this guide in three passes

Before a session, retrieve five phrases without looking. During practice, use the grammar frames as a reference. After attempting the exercises, record one error pattern and create a new example.

Chapter	What to retrieve
01 / Vocabulary & Collocations	Precise meanings; whole phrases; verb and preposition patterns.
02 / Grammar & Use of English	Preferences; passive meanings; agreement; contrast; polite questions.
03 / Exam Skills & Practice	Task fulfilment; paragraph purpose; developed speech; changing intentions.

Your four sessions remain independent

The class is recommended, not compulsory. It does not unlock or block any session. You can continue the course and request optional AI feedback without a teacher approving your work.

Make vocabulary active

Record a meaning in English, a natural phrase and one new example. Say the phrase, change part of it, then retrieve it tomorrow. A familiar translation alone is not enough to use a word accurately.

Original practice material for Aptis B2 preparation. Not an official British Council publication.

VOCABULARY / 01

Meanings and useful patterns

Learn the whole pattern and create a different sentence. The examples below use situations outside the weekly questions.

Word or phrase	Meaning in English	Useful pattern
payable	required to be paid, or paid to a particular recipient	payable within fourteen days
affordable	within someone's financial means	affordable for young families
valuable	worth much, or providing significant usefulness	valuable insight
confirm	establish or state that information is correct	confirm an observation
approve	give permission or formal agreement	approve a research proposal
admit	acknowledge something, often reluctantly	admit a calculation error
enquire	ask for information	enquire about membership
exception	a case treated differently from a general rule	make an exception to a policy
beginner	a person starting to learn a skill	a beginner in pottery
comprehensive	covering all relevant or necessary areas	a comprehensive safety guide
refund	money returned after it was paid	receive a refund after a cancellation
discount	a reduction in a price	offer a student discount
current	existing or happening now	the current exhibition
retain	continue to have something	retain original photographs
obtain	acquire something	obtain permission

Retrieval task: cover the middle column and explain five meanings aloud. Then change the example to fit your own experience.

VOCABULARY / 02

Meanings and useful patterns

Learn the whole pattern and create a different sentence. The examples below use situations outside the weekly questions.

Word or phrase	Meaning in English	Useful pattern
remind	prompt someone to remember	remind someone to recharge a battery
comply	act in accordance with a requirement	comply with environmental legislation
widespread	present among many people or in many places	widespread interest in conservation
inaccessible	not readily reachable or usable	a document inaccessible to a screen reader
constructive	helping a situation move towards improvement	constructive criticism
accommodate	make arrangements that meet needs; also provide lodging	accommodate different learning preferences
distinguish	recognise or show a difference	distinguish between an original and a reproduction
recipient	a person receiving something	the recipient of an award
dispatch	send something to a destination	dispatch a rescue team
depot	a place where vehicles or goods are stored or handled	a railway maintenance depot
handling	the way something is dealt with or physically managed	safe handling of fragile objects
coordinator	a person organising different activities or people	the festival coordinator
inclusive	enabling different people to take part	an inclusive choir rehearsal
on behalf of	representing another person or organisation	speak on behalf of a charity
collection window	a specified period during which collection is possible	a collection window for repaired instruments

Retrieval task: cover the middle column and explain five meanings aloud. Then change the example to fit your own experience.

GRAMMAR / FOUR CORE PATTERNS

Meaning before form

Identify who acts and what relationship you want to express. Then choose a complete grammatical frame.

1 / Preferences

Same subject: would rather + base verb. Another subject: would rather + subject + past form for a present or future preference. Would prefer normally takes to + infinitive.

I'd rather paint outdoors. I'd rather my sister drove us there. I'd prefer to travel early.

2 / Necessary work

Need + -ing can have passive meaning in British English. Need + to be + past participle gives an equivalent passive. A person who performs the action can need to + base verb.

The car needs washing. The car needs to be washed. The owner needs to wash the car.

3 / Neither ... nor

Both alternatives are excluded. With mixed singular and plural subjects, the nearer subject normally guides agreement. Recast awkward combinations when writing freely.

Neither the coach nor the players are ready. Neither the players nor the coach is ready.

4 / Contrast

Despite and in spite of take a noun phrase or -ing form. Although takes a subject and a finite verb. Do not use despite of.

Despite the fog, the pilot landed safely. Although visibility was poor, the landing was safe.

Independent practice

Make one fresh example for each rule. Do not copy a weekly question and replace only one word. Check the meaning, subject and complete structure before checking individual endings.

WRITING TOOLKIT / ACCURATE CONNECTIONS

Useful language, clear purpose

These are reusable frames, not a ready-made answer to an academy task.

Pattern	New example
remind someone to + verb	Please remind the visitors to bring a sunhat.
remind someone about + noun	The message reminded us about the rehearsal.
enquire about / comply with	Enquire about membership; comply with environmental legislation.
responsible for / in someone's care	Responsible for feeding the birds; animals in the team's care.
distinguish between A and B	Distinguish between an original painting and a reproduction.
take X into account / set priorities	Take the nesting season into account; set priorities for restoration.
make an exception / come into effect	Make an exception to a policy; new noise rules come into effect.

Polite indirect questions

Use statement order inside the embedded question. Use whether or if for yes-or-no questions. Choose a clear introduction for the information you need.

> Where does the trail end? / Could you tell me where the trail ends?

Proposals, passives and conditions

Suggest + -ing; modal + be + past participle. Use could for an option and might for a possibility. Check that a proposal respects the notice.

> I suggest displaying larger labels. Paintings must be protected from sunlight. If a guide is absent, a volunteer could lead the tour.

Avoid these common errors

Do not mix I'd rather with to + verb. Do not use needs to drying. Do not write despite of. Do not invert the embedded question after could you tell me. Do not use suggest me to when recommending an action.

EXAM STRATEGY / FINAL CHECK

Plan, attempt, then review

A correct method helps you make a decision. It does not replace reading the actual task carefully.

Writing

Identify the reader and every requested action. Cover each content point before polishing style. Your weekly ranges are Part 2: 20-30 words; Part 3: 30-40 per response; Part 4: 40-50 informal and 120-150 formal. Follow the range printed on the actual task.

> Short-answer teaching example / A neighbourhood picnic I would bring a board game because it is easy to share and gives neighbours who have not met before a natural way to start talking. 26 words: an item plus a reason. Use your own idea in practice.

Reading

Skim the route of the text, label each paragraph's job, match main ideas and review overlaps. A repeated word is not enough evidence. In the new garden example, a shift from watering to improving the soil supports a change-of-method heading.

Speaking

Describe visible evidence; signal speculation with might or perhaps. Use past forms for a personal event and develop general opinions with reasons. Compare a relevant dimension rather than two isolated descriptions. Part 1: 30 seconds each; Parts 2-3: 45 seconds each; Part 4: one minute preparation and two minutes speaking.

Listening

Separate the original plan, later choice and next action. In the new ferry/train example, the final transport is the train and the sister makes the booking. Academy listening is unlimited; use replay to analyse evidence. Attempt the task before consulting its transcript.

Final checklist

[ ] I can retrieve five phrases with meanings and new examples.

[ ] I can explain four grammar patterns rather than recite answers.

[ ] My writing addresses every requested point and the correct reader.

[ ] My reading choice reflects the whole paragraph's purpose.

[ ] My speech answers the actual prompt and develops a relevant idea.

[ ] My listening choice follows the final decision, not just the first word.